SCIENCE DEPARTMENT • SCIENCE LITERACY & LESSON INTERNALIZATION

PD AGENDA

Strengthening Science Literacy: Calibrating Writing Benchmarks, Feedback, and Revision

Strategy Focus: Teaching Students to Analyze Science Sources With CUBS + CER — adapt a student-facing path from source analysis to an evidence-based explanation, feedback, and revision.

WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 28, 2026 • 2:30–3:30 P.M. **60 MINUTES** **GRADES 9–12 SCIENCE • BRING FORMS & EVIDENCE**

TODAY'S OUTCOME Leave with a ready-to-teach CUBS/CER routine, an existing reading/article-analysis or writing strategy to share—or a CUBS/CER move to try next—plus a feedback/revision move, colleague idea, and Friday evidence plan.

WHY THIS PLC MATTERS Every science course asks students to interpret information and explain scientific thinking. CUBS and color-coded CER make source analysis, evidence use, and reasoning visible while students remain responsible for the thinking.

PROTOCOL CONNECTION
Every Day Questions 1, 3, and 4; Team Deep Dive Steps 2–4: clarify the learning goal and mastery bar, anticipate student responses and access needs, and plan the student experience, feedback, and revision moves.

WHAT TO BRING
One course-specific source or response task; 1–2 de-identified writing samples; current standard(s); student-facing materials; CER-color highlighters; Lesson Internalization Tool; and planning materials.

FOCUS TO PROTECT
The Biology benchmark is available only as an optional model. Every science teacher adapts CUBS and color-coded CER to an authentic course source and task. The routine supports students in doing the task; it is not an additional grading system.

TODAY'S PLC PLAN

TIME (MIN)	FOCUS	WHAT TO DO	PRODUCT / CHECK
2:30–2:41	**Frame the science literacy cycle**	Connect Monday's task experience and Tuesday's planning to the course-wide process: analyze a source, construct an evidence-based explanation, use feedback, and revise.	**Purpose + learning arc**
2:41–3:00	**Model CUBS + practice a course source**	Think aloud CUBS moves, then apply them to an authentic article, data display, diagram, model, investigation result, or task. The Biology benchmark is optional only.	**Source analysis**
3:00–3:15	**Color-code CER + plan feedback/revision**	Use a de-identified writing sample to make claim, evidence, reasoning, and linking language visible; plan a prompt and revision action tied to the mastery bar.	**Response + feedback**
3:15–3:22	**Teacher reading + writing strategy share**	Two or three teachers share another strategy students use to read/analyze a science article/source or write an explanation; discuss what works and any challenge. Teachers not using a strategy yet choose a CUBS/CER move from this PD to try next.	**Colleague learning**
3:22–3:28	**Course-alike adaptation + LIT reflection**	Use the reflection sheet during PD to record the LIT-aligned task, existing strategy to share or CUBS/CER move to try, writing-sample evidence, feedback/revision, colleague idea, and next step.	**Ready-to-teach plan**
3:28–3:30	**Close + evidence plan**	Teach the routine, complete the after-PD reflection and next step, record the evidence to collect, and bring a small de-identified set of completed writing and feedback/revision evidence Friday.	**Friday bridge**

PROTECTED INDIVIDUAL WORK WITH COLLEAGUE SUPPORT

WORK WITH COLLEAGUES

WHAT TO DO Share another reading/article-analysis or writing strategy you use: What works? What needs attention? If you do not use one yet, select a CUBS/CER move to try next. Record a colleague idea, feedback/revision move, and evidence check.

1. **Select your source + task:** Use a text, graph, data display, diagram, model, investigation result, or scenario.
2. **Model CUBS:** Make source-analysis moves visible before students explain.
3. **Calibrate CER colors:** Help students see the claim, evidence, reasoning, and transitions in a response.
4. **Plan feedback + revision:** Write ready-to-use directions, a feedback prompt, and a revision action.
5. **Share or choose + reflect:** Share a reading or writing strategy—or choose a CUBS/CER move to try next—then record a colleague idea and Friday evidence.

USE THIS REFERENCE DURING GROUP WORK

ADAPT THE ROUTINE TO YOUR SCIENCE COURSE
Begin with an authentic source and response task. Clarify what students must notice, explain, and make visible in a complete response.

CUBS + COLOR-CODED CER MAKE THINKING VISIBLE
Students use CUBS to analyze the source and label their claim, evidence, and reasoning so they can see what is present, partial, missing, or not connected.

FEEDBACK MUST LEAD TO REVISION
Share another reading/article-analysis or writing strategy that works; if you are not using one yet, select a CUBS/CER move to try. Then use a criterion-based feedback prompt that leads to a specific revision.

COLLABORATION IN PRACTICE Protect time for thoughtful individual work; use respectful, student-centered feedback to make the next decision clearer.
TEACHER RUBRIC CONNECTION **Standard I: I-A-4 Well-Structured Lessons • Standard II: II-A-2 Student Engagement • Standard II: II-D-2 High Expectations • Standard IV: IV-C-1 Professional Collaboration**

